

Fearnleys Weekly Report

Week 40 - September 30, 2026

info@hellenicshippingnews.com

01 Tankers

VLCC

There has been a perceived slowdown in activity over the last few days and a bit of “profit taking” would always be expected in a market yielding USD 750-800k/day (the cost of waiting is the same). However, a lot of under the radar fixing has been concluded with rates continuing to trade in the mid- to high WS 700’s from Fujairah to Far East destination and into the WS 800-900’s for shorter options. Saudi having restarted operations on the East-West Pipeline has prompted fresh enquiries from Yanbu, with two Korean charterers forking out USD 55 million for the longer route via the Suez Canal and COGH. The southbound route via Bab al-Mandab is considered too risky as the Houthis are now in full control of the Strait. The US announced another 40 million bbls SPR release yesterday, and with the arb fully open we could easily see rates along the lines of those Yanbu fixtures or above for USG/Far East. Crude oil exports from Middle East producers have rebounded in September to 16.328 mbpd, the highest since the Iran war began on February 28, and with flows through

war levels which is a remarkable recovery for a region still at war. Position lists are still tight, and the weather is not helping, all in all a perfect storm (no pun intended).

Suezmax

Limited supply and heavy demand, not just working but expected too, plagues/boosts the Atlantic basin significantly. The only weights on the market are CPC & Fujairah, where activity on Suezmaxes remain muted. TD6 has failed to move up in line with the Atlantic, is likely close to finalising the October programme, after which over a week of silence would be expected before the November programme is released. Fujairah action on VLCC has been plentiful, so an absence of Suezmax activity likely reflects the efficiencies charterers are prioritising regarding STS operations amidst compromised local logistics rather than a pricing issue. The opposite could be true in Brazil where seasonal local conditions may promote Suezmax utilisation even if VLCCs continue to lag on rates. With VLCC presence off end/early dates West Africa & Brazil close to zero, TA & Eastbound arbs open ex USG and AFRAs achieving high freight rates for USG/TA runs we expect strong demand fundamentals to continue to feed this Suezmax market.

Aframax

North Sea

A slow start to the week with relets getting programmed and some dates moving in the West Coast Norway programs. Rates remain firm with list continuing to be thinned with vessels heading both to the US and Mediterranean for longer more attractive returns especially those that have missed the dates and are looking at significant waiting time. Natural window will start to push into end of the 1st / early 2nd decade as we head towards the end of the week. 10-20 dates on paper look busier stem wise than 1-10 dates so market to remain firm it looks like for the time being at least.

Mediterranean

Steady activity in the Mediterranean/Black Sea with charterers now trying to cover as quietly as possibly their cargoes. List is somewhat balanced with the prompt vessels looking to ballast TA and then everyone is looking for the best available dates. TD19 was slightly down after a couple of days of firming but the sentiment on the owners' side remains firm.

Dirty

(Spot WS 2026, Daily Change)

 Click rate to view graph

MEG/WEST

625

280'

0 >

MEG/Japan

1,150

280'

0 >

MEG/Singapore

1,175

280'

0 >

WAF/FEAST

495

260'

-30 ▼

WAF/USAC

457.5

130'

20 ▲

Sidi Kerir/W Med

510

135'

20 ▲

N. Afr/Euromed

80'

UK/Cont

80'

415

 15 

Caribs/USG

70'

645

 155 

1 Year T/C - ECO / SCRUBBER

(USD/Day, Weekly Change)

 Click rate to view graph

VLCC

Modern

\$185,000

 \$15,000 

Suezmax

Modern

\$137,500

 \$2,500 

Aframax

Modern

\$79,000

 \$0 

VLCCs

 Click rate to view graph

38

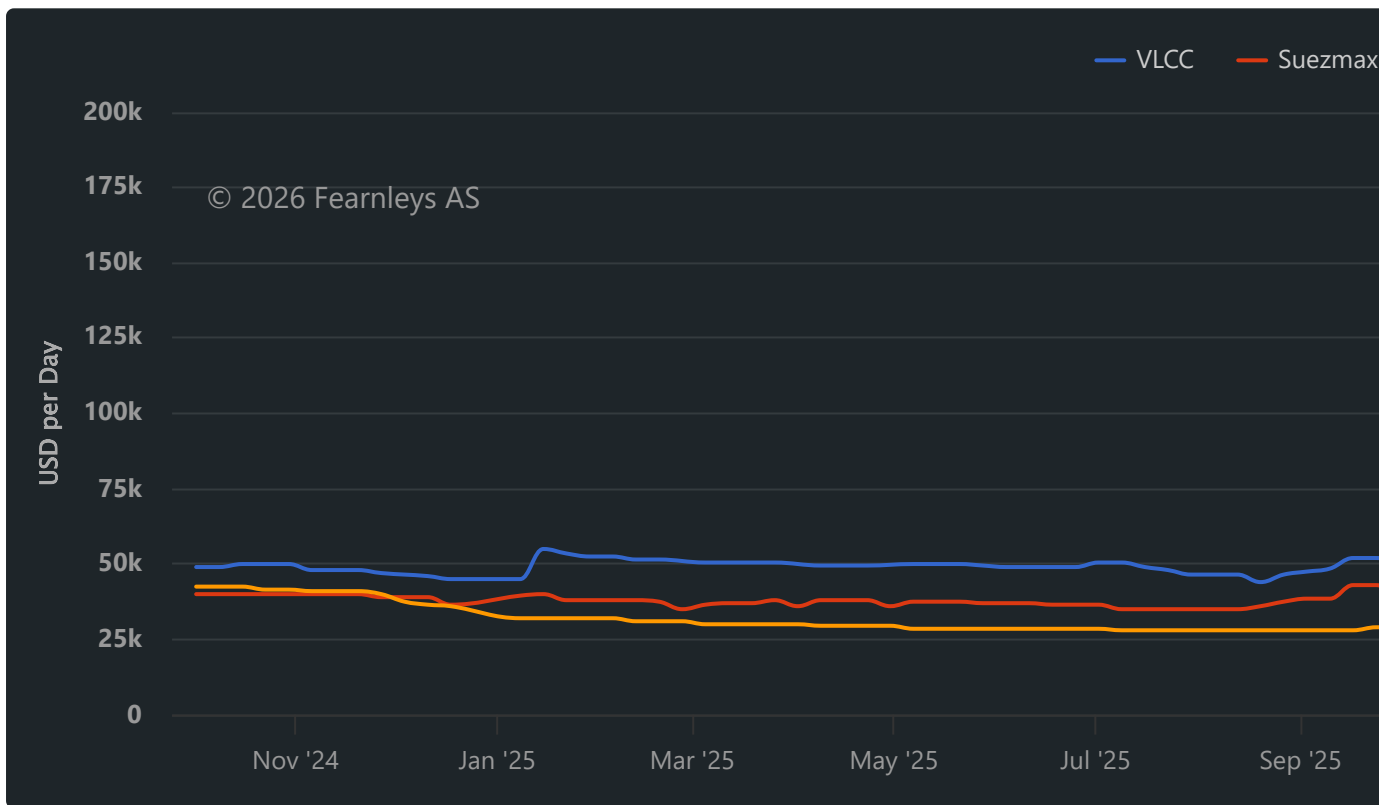
-5▼

Available in MEG next 30 days

93

8▲

1 Year T/C Crude



02 **Dry Bulk**

Capes across all segments were in decline this week amid a clear imbalance of tonnage and demand, with Pacific leading the softening. With FFAs showing more positive sentiment in the days to come, we hope to see improved market levels going forward. Pacific C5 West Australia/Qingdao prints USD 13.44 today on the Baltic Exchange, down from USD 16.27 last week - indicating a fairly rapid decline in Pacific markets. Earlier week fixtures were recorded in the USD 13.70-13.80 levels, while this morning we saw fixtures at USD 13.45 ex Dampier/Qingdao. With Iron Ore prices softening due to weaker demand and high inventory (especially ahead of the China National Holiday) we expect to see some further weakening in Australia markets in the short term. C3 Brazil/China has also seen a downturn this week, following expanding tonnage lists and minimal cargo flow out of Brazil, with market levels falling below the USD 40s levels, today printing USD 38.6 on the Baltic (dropping from a previous high of USD 43.12 just one week ago). Owners are holding their offers, hovering around USD 39-40 levels today, with many choosing to stay quiet with the hope of renewed premium rates. Fresh stems ex West Africa and Brazil are collecting ideas in the USD 37 levels this morning, and several offers in USD 40-41 levels have been recorded today with little traction. Both basins show a defensive outlook moving forward as market pressure increases, and some owners are choosing to ballast to the North Atlantic as some fresh stems for November laycans offer potential premium returns. FFA going forward shows some promise, with levels showing some improvement.

Panamax

The Panamax market has held a broadly steady tone this week, with the two basins moving in opposite directions and largely offsetting one another. The Atlantic remains the firmer of the two: North and South American mineral and grain programs have kept the cargo book healthy, prompt tonnage in the North Continent and West Mediterranean has tightened, and owners have held their ideas on both transatlantic rounds and fronthaul business. The Pacific, by contrast, has softened as Indonesian inquiry thinned and Australian volumes eased ahead of the Chinese holidays, leaving charterers with the initiative and bid-offer spreads wider than of late. Period inquiries remain reasonably active across both sizes, although owners' ideas continue to sit above the level at which charterers are prepared to clear, and the forward curve carries only modest backwardation. We look for a sideways-to-slightly-softer tone into next



the Q4 grain program providing the more supportive backdrop into the 2H October.

Supramax

The Supramax market remained generally firm, supported by improved demand in the US Gulf, steady South Atlantic activity, and strong Continent demand driven by scrap, while the Mediterranean stayed softer due to limited cargo. The Handysize market was more mixed, with the Continent and Mediterranean remaining healthy, Atlantic sentiment varying with some improved charterer interest but quieter activity on certain routes, while Pacific softened slightly amid less cargo enquiry and slower activity.

Rates

Capesize

(USD/Day, USD/Tonne, Daily Change)

 Click rate to view graph

TCE Cont/Far East

\$86,344

-\$839▼

Australia/China

\$13.45

-\$0.27▼

Pacific RV

\$34,364

-\$1,306▼

Panamax

(USD/Day, USD/Tonne, Daily Change)

 Click rate to view graph

\$21,673

-\$50▼

TCE Cont/Far East

\$30,761

-\$76▼

TCE Far East/Cont

\$13,150

-\$19▼

TCE Far East RV

\$20,878

-\$169▼

Supramax

(USD/Day, USD/Tonne, Daily Change)

 Click rate to view graph

Transatlantic RV

\$24,013

-\$176▼

US Gulf - China/South Japan

\$32,906

-\$138▼

South China - Indonesia RV

1 Year T/C

(USD/Day, Weekly Change)

 Click rate to view graph

Newcastlemax

208'

\$47,345

-\$3,038 

Kamsarmax

82'

\$23,000

-\$250 

Ultramax

64'

\$20,000

-\$1,000 

Capesize

180'

\$34,678

-\$2,451 

Panamax

75'

\$20,500

-\$250 

Supramax

58'

\$18,000

-\$500 

\$15,000

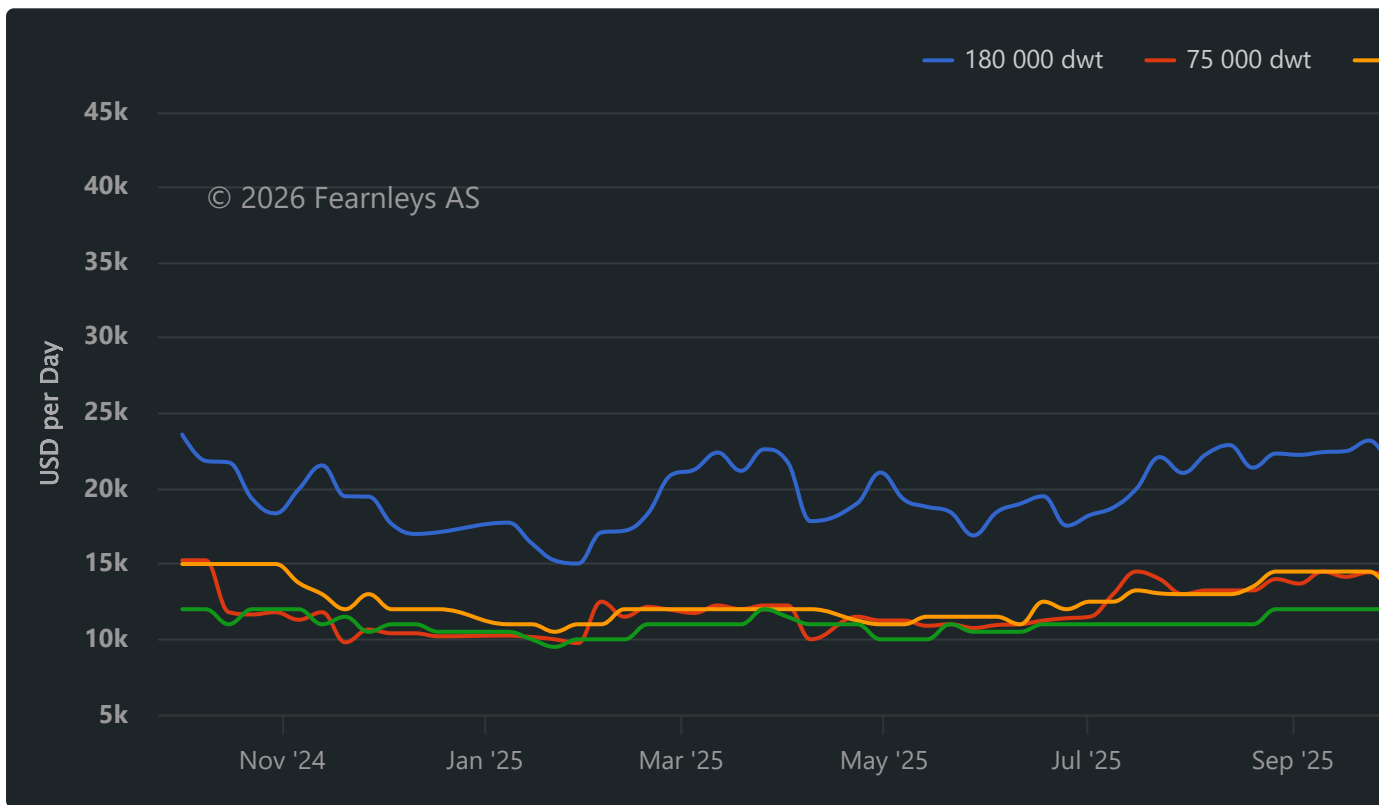
-\$1,000▼

Baltic Dry Index (BDI)

\$3,113

-\$65▼

1 Year T/C Dry Bulk



03
Gas

One fixture this week, with rates continuing to rise and freight sitting around USD 200 kpd. Further interest for end-October, with few options left: only 2 ships remain. November shows 10 ships in the first decade and 4 in the second decade. The week has been quiet so far with the arb coming in. Panama Canal conditions have improved, though seasonal Christmas import volumes may tighten slot availability from October.

LPG Rates

Spot Market
(USD/Month, Weekly Change)

 Click rate to view graph

VLGC	84'
\$6,300,000	\$170,000 

LGC	60'
\$3,500,000	\$0 

MGC	38'
\$1,800,000	\$0 

HDY SR	20-22'
\$980,000	\$0 

HDY ETH	20-24'
\$1,400,000	\$0 

\$610,000

-\$20,000▼

SR

6.5'

\$560,000

-\$20,000▼

COASTER Europe (3 500-5 000 cbm)

\$450,000

-\$25,000▼

LPG/FOB Prices (Propane)

(USD/Tonne, Weekly Change)

 Click rate to view graph

FOB North Sea/Ansi

\$526.5

\$0 >

Saudi Arabia/CP

\$625

\$0 >

MT Belvieu (US Gulf)

\$446.75

\$19.21▲

Sonatrach/Bethioua

LPG/FOB Prices (Butane)

(USD/Tonne, Weekly Change)

 Click rate to view graph

FOB North Sea/Ansi

\$600

\$0 >

Saudi Arabia/CP

\$660

\$0 >

MT Belvieu (US Gulf)

\$600.5

\$45.01 ^

Sonatrach/Bethioua

\$610

\$0 >

LNG Rates

Spot Market

(USD/Day, Weekly Change)

 Click rate to view graph

East of Suez MEGI / XDF

West of Suez MEGI / XDF

\$32,000

\$2,000 

1 Year T/C MEGI / XDF

\$55,000

\$0 

04

Newbuilding

Activity Levels

Tank Activity

Strong

Dry Bulk Activity

Increasing

LNG Activity

LPG Activity

Strong

Container Activity

Strong

Other Activity

Moderate

Prices

VLCC

\$130

300'

\$0 >

Suezmax

\$85

150'

\$0 >

Aframax

\$74

110'

\$0 >

\$49.5

\$0 >

Newcastlemax

210'

\$82

\$0 >

Kamsarmax

82'

\$38.5

\$0 >

Ultramax

64'

\$36

\$0 >

LNGC (MEGI) (cbm)

170'

\$250

\$0 >

05

Sale & Purchase

Prices

Capesize	\$75.0	\$60.0
Kamsarmax	\$41.0	\$32.0
Ultramax	\$39.0	\$30.0
Handysize	\$31.0	\$24.0

Wet	5 yr old	10 yr old
VLCC	\$185.0	\$160.0
Suezmax	\$115.0	\$100.0
Aframax / LR2	\$86.0	\$75.5

06

Market Brief

Exchange Rates

USD/JPY

157.12

0.24^

USD/NOK

9.58

0.07^

1,235.5

-7.3✓

EUR/USD

1.14

0 >

Interest Rates

SOFR USD (Overnight)

3.65%

-0.01✓

Commodity Prices

Brent Spot

\$83.97

\$0.42^{\wedge}

Bunker Prices

Singapore

380 CST

\$458

-\$1▼

\$902

\$19.5^

Spread MGO/380 CST

\$444

\$20.5^

Rotterdam

380 CST

\$453.5

-\$4v

MGO

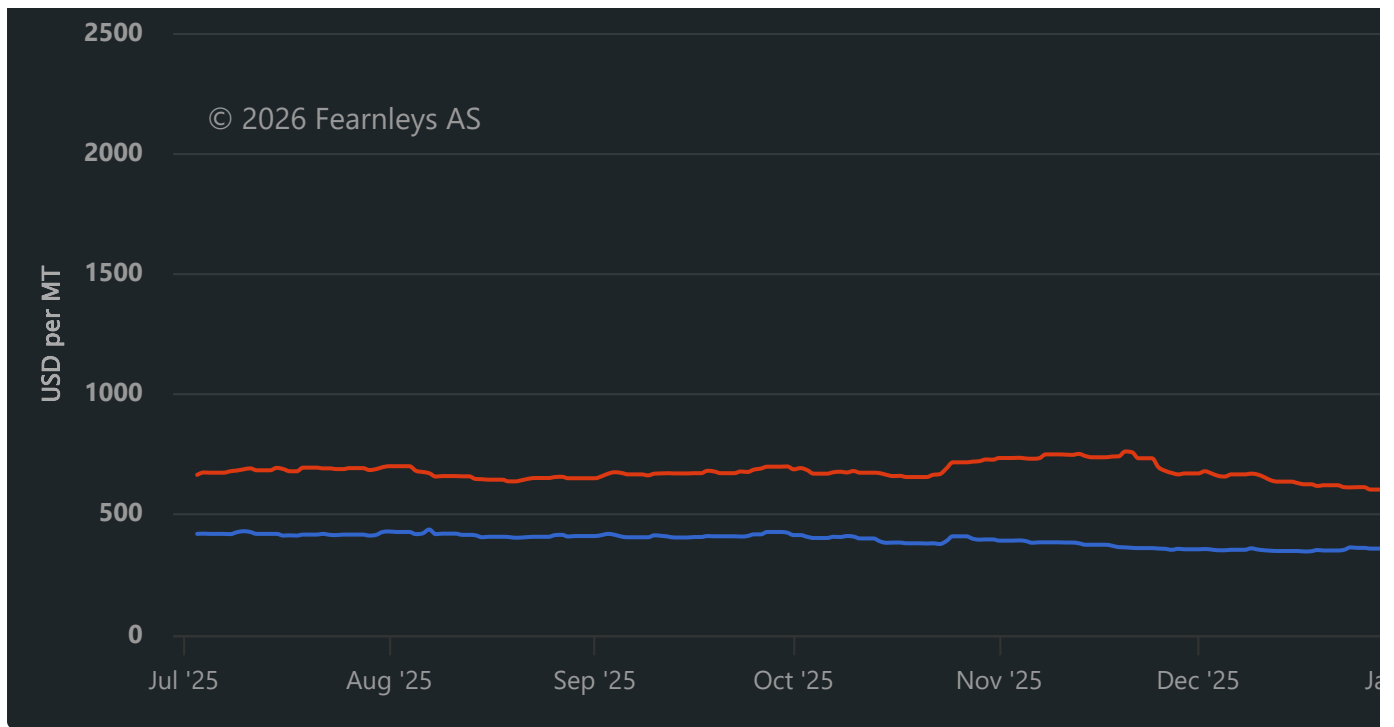
\$899

\$24^

Spread MGO/380 CST

\$445.5

\$28^



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All rates published in this report do not necessarily reflect actual transactions occurring in the market. Certain estimates may be based on prevailing market conditions. In some circumstances, rates for certain vessel types are based on theoretical assumptions of premium or discount for particular vessel versus other vessel types.'

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